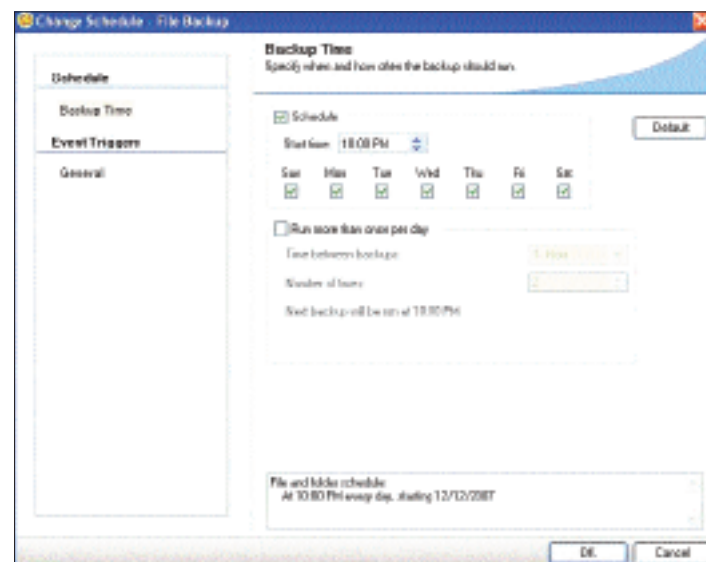
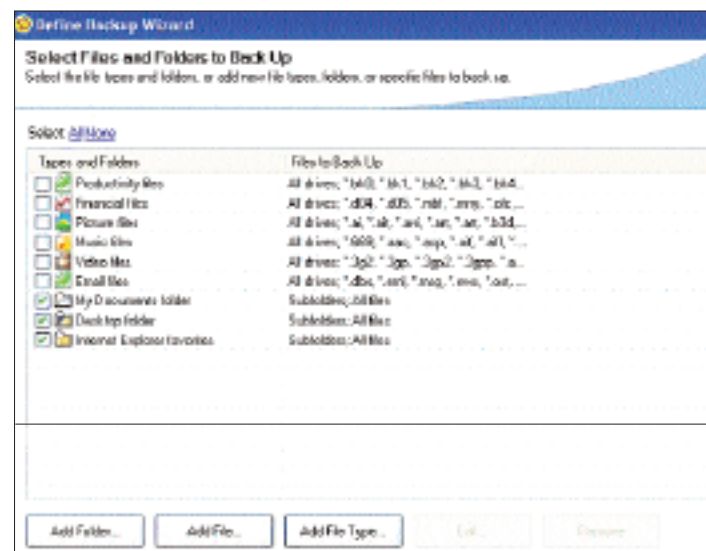




Schedules can be set for backup, at your convenience



You can choose to back up only select file types

you to back up more than once in a day, which is ideal for a busy day at office. Backups, especially image-based backups, are a performance hog when they run, and Norton Ghost has a Progress and Performance feature which allows you to slow down the backup if you are in the middle of something. You can even back up systems that are dual-booted.

The backup sets can be burnt onto CD / DVD or transferred onto a USB drive. Security for your backups is rock solid—the files are protected by 256-bit AES encryption, one of the best methods. Apart from scheduled backups, backups can also be triggered by user-set events like the installation of a new application, or when the size of the backup source folders increases beyond a certain limit. Multiple computers running Ghost can be controlled remotely from a single machine. (Each computer needs to have an unique license key, so this proposition would be very costly if your network is large.)

Restore times depend on the amount of data that is imaged. However, the process is easy—it is basic point-and-click. If you have no time to do an

image backup. Ghost will let you do an individual backup of files and folders. It will do incremental backups when space is a concern. The backup files can be searched either through Ghost's inbuilt feature, or synced with Google Desktop Search.

Norton Ghost is a costly choice, but it does its job pretty well. The documentation is pretty detailed, and technical support can be obtained via e-mail. For more details on how to use Norton Ghost like a Pro, check out this month's *30 Minute Expert* in our *Tips & Tricks* section.

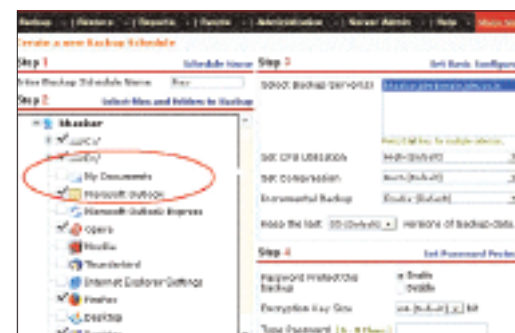
Vembu StoreGrid Backup Software

For those businesses that run more than one computer, this is a godsend. Each computer on the network usually has some free space. Vembu StoreGrid allows you to back up data across an intranet utilising this free space. Find the software on our August 2007 DVD. The free edition runs on Windows, though the paid versions run across all platforms.

Unlike Norton Ghost, StoreGrid runs very well on systems with average system specifications. The free version does not have all the features of the paid one, but it does the job of backing up your files. Some nice features are the ability to do incremental backups by default—StoreGrid will back up changes each time they appear in the file, but it won't save multiple copies of the same file. Rather, the changes will appear in a single file, which results in space and time savings.

If you've spent hours tweaking your Registry for optimum performance, those changes can be saved, too. User data is encrypted up to 448 bits using the Blowfish algorithm, and is password-protected. StoreGrid supports hardware like Network Attached Storage (NAS) and external hard drives. The Pro version has the feature to back up files via secure FTP (File Transfer Protocol). It also stores Outlook, Outlook Express, and browser settings and will back up data to Microsoft SQL and Exchange Server.

The interface is intuitive, and setting up the software is easy. There are three modes of configuring the software. The first is client / server



The browser-based console in Vembu



Configuring Vembu for a network is as simple as adding IP addresses.

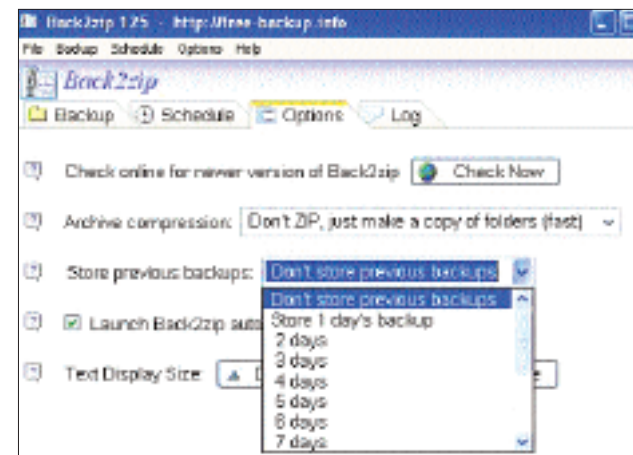
mode, in which the computer can be used to store backups of other systems and also back up its own data to others. The other two options are client and server: systems configured for the client mode cannot have backups of other systems stored on their hard drives, while systems configured for server mode cannot have their data backed up elsewhere.

Control is through a browser-based interface, and you need to type **http://localhost:6060** into your browser's address bar to start the console. Backups can be scheduled on a calendar, or set up so that every time a file is updated, it is backed up. For users who use both a laptop and a Desktop, StoreGrid can be configured such that data on specific folders on laptops will be automatically backed up on connecting to the network.

Back2Zip

For those on a budget, Back2Zip is a simple and effective data backup software. It is freeware; find it on this month's CD.

This is a no-nonsense, no-frills software. It sports an extremely simple interface with a minimum of options, but does all that you'd expect it to do. It can either do a simple copy, or compress the files into zipped folders; the level of compression can be set to low or high. (The higher the compression, the slower the backup.) Back2Zip backs up whole files and folders; it is not image backup. The duration between successive backups can be set from 20 minutes to 6 hours; the 20-minute option is ideal when you are working on important documents.



Multiple backups of the same file can be archived by Back2Zip.

This software leaves a very small footprint. The compression method used is the industry-standard ZIP and ZIP-64.

Over The Wires

Online backup is typically a costly option for individuals and small businesses because of recurring costs, but you can get some good bargains if you hunt for them. Some companies like IDrive (www.idrive.com), Mozy (<http://mozy.com/>), and Carbonite (www.carbonite.com) offer packages tailored to the needs of individuals and small businesses. The offerings are comparable in terms of cost. IDrive, for example,

offers 2 GB of storage space for free, with unlimited space for personal use at \$49.50 (Rs 2,000) per year, and 50 GB to 500 GB for businesses at yearly rates starting from \$99.50 (Rs 4,000). These services typically require the installation of a client on the local machine; this is used to control settings and options. They offer the full range of features, right from scheduled backups to encryption—just like those offered by Desktop software.

At The End Of It

For a SoHo user, the best solution would be to use backup software and back up data to another hard disk, preferably an external drive. It is not advisable to use another internal disk to back up the data, as both data and backup could be lost at the same time.

External hard disks are pretty affordable these days—a 160 GB drive, for example, costs between Rs 4,500 and 6,000 (internal hard drives of the same capacity cost about Rs 3,000). Since you can carry all the data with you, you have yourself a great solution.

Online backup can be expensive or affordable depending on your budget, needs, and connectivity. It's definitely worth considering. ■

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Flash Memory	Optional
Preinstalled OS	Optional (Linux, WinCE, WinXP)
Graphic	16 pin D type female VGA connector
Parallel interface	10/100Mbps, Normal RJ45 type cabling
Wireless	Optional
Hard-disk	(Optional) 2.5" Laptop HDD
I/O	1 Parallel, 4 USB, 1 Serial, PS2 Kbrd & Mouse con.
Audio	Ac97 codec
Power	± 12V @ 6A (60 watts only)
Dimensions	225" x 80" x 8"
Weight	1.5 Kg
Platform supported	KDP, ICA, XUN, VNC, NX, Telnet, ssh
OS supported	Win NT/2K/XP, Linux, DOS
Local device supported	Parallel/USB & Serial printers, Pen-drives, CD-ROM, Floppy, devices like bar code scanner etc.